

ROUND: keep the promise specific

A small check can earn a useful amount of trust

01 / THE SAS EXAMPLE

```
data test;
  input value;
  rounded = round(value);
  datalines;
2.3
2.7
-1.4
-1.6
3.0
;
run;

proc print data=test noobs;
run;
```

REPORTED TEST SETUP / 21 SEP 2026
Claude Sonnet 4.5 / AWS Bedrock GovCloud
Claude Code 2.1.278 / effortLevel=high / prompt v0.1.0

ATTACH SOURCE OR PASTE IT AFTER THE PROMPT. START FRESH EACH TIME.

WHAT YOU WILL PRACTICE

Match a simple conversion to an explicit scope and a compact result check.

Round five positive and negative numbers to the nearest integer. None is a halfway value. This exercise establishes agreement only for these supplied values.

EXPECTED RESULT

Row	value	rounded
1	2.3	2
2	2.7	3
3	-1.4	-1
4	-1.6	-2
5	3.0	3

Five non-halfway inputs only; numeric 2 equals 2.0.

REPORTED NUMERIC MATCHES / FIVE INPUTS
Prompt A 3/3 | Prompt B 3/3

Reference values checked in Python; SAS execution pending.

Prompt A: leave choices open

High degrees of freedom / Notice the decisions the model makes for you.

COPY THIS PROMPT + THE SAS EXAMPLE

Convert this SAS code to Python.

Show code in this response. Do not create or run files, or read existing Python files.

REPORTED TRIAL RESULTS / 21 SEP 2026

Matching numbers, conflicting explanations

Run	Method	Values	Explanation
A1	.round()	Yes	Wrong SAS rounding claim
A2	.round()	Yes	Correct + alternative recipe
A3	.round()	Yes	Correct + scope note

A1 wrongly said SAS and pandas both use ties-to-even.

Correct output and correct explanation are separate checks.

All A runs matched [2, 3, -1, -2, 3].

SOURCES: results-20260921.csv; trial-log-20260921.md; analysis-20260921.md

WHY CHOICES REMAIN OPEN

- 1

A1's explanation was wrong
At exact halfway values, SAS ROUND rounds away from zero; pandas rounds to even. These inputs do not test that difference.
- 2

A2 and A3 recognized the difference
A2 offered a floor/ceil alternative. A3 correctly explained that this fixture has no halfway values.
- 3

Keep the conclusion within scope
Five matching outputs do not establish equivalence for all SAS ROUND inputs or other rounding units.

ANTI-PATTERN: ACCEPTING OUTPUT AS PROOF

Review the explanation as well as the values. A correct result on this fixture cannot validate an untested general claim.

Expand the checks when the required scope expands.

Prompt B: make the choices explicit

Low degrees of freedom / State the behavior, then ask for a check.

COPY THIS PROMPT + THE SAME SAS EXAMPLE

```
Convert this SAS code to Python using pandas.
- Build a DataFrame with value in the original row order:
  [2.3, 2.7, -1.4, -1.6, 3.0].
- Create rounded using the value Series .round(0) method.
- Print value and rounded. Numeric 2 and 2.0 are equivalent here.
- Include an assertion that rounded values are [2, 3, -1, -2, 3].
- Briefly explain what the check covers: these five inputs,
  nearest-integer rounding, including the negative inputs.
- State that halfway values and other rounding units have not
  been tested. Keep those cases outside this exercise.
```

Show code in this response. Do not create or run files, or read existing Python files.

WHY THESE DETAILS HELP

- 1 Choose one route**
Name pandas and .round(0). All three B runs report the requested method.
- 2 Define numeric agreement**
Check the list [2, 3, -1, -2, 3] in order. Numeric 2 and 2.0 count as equal here.
- 3 State the limits of the check**
B1-B3 reportedly included the requested scope note: halfway inputs and other rounding units were not tested.

REPORTED RESULTS / THREE B RUNS

Run	Numeric match	Scope note
B1	Yes	Included
B2	Yes	Included
B3	Yes	Included

CHECK IT YOURSELF
Assert all five rounded values in order.
Keep inputs unchanged; record the scope of the pass.